THE AI-POWERED PROJECT MANAGER

Companion Practical Lab Pack | Edition 1.0

Five fictional datasets • Five guided labs • Verification keys • Skills assessment

Companion to the 219-page V30 manuscript. This is a separate training supplement, not a replacement for the original chapters. All organizations, records, amounts and incidents below are fictional.

How to run the labs

Use only an organization-approved AI environment. Upload one dataset at a time. Preserve original files and record the model/tool, prompt version, timestamp, input filename, output, manual corrections, reviewer and disposition. Never treat generated owners, approvals, dates or calculations as verified facts.

CRAFT: Context, Role, Ask, Format, Test. **Evidence:** FACT, ASSUMPTION, INFERENCE, UNKNOWN. **Operating model:** Context → Task → AI → Validate → Decide → Act.

Lab sequence and deliverables

Lab	Dataset	Deliverable	Chapter link
1	Meeting evidence	Decision/action register + evidence map	3, 8
2	Sprint delivery	Status and blocker analysis	5, 6
3	RAID dependencies	Linked exposure and escalation brief	7
4	Financial scenarios	Verified EAC/VAC/margin options	9
5	Release readiness	Decision-ready go/no-go pack	10, 11

LAB 1 — Evidence-grounded meeting intelligence

Input: 01_meeting_transcript_evidence.csv

Management objective: Extract decisions, actions, risks and unresolved questions; attach line IDs and distinguish commitments from estimates.

Copy-ready CRAFT prompt:

Context: I am conducting a fictional IT delivery management exercise using the attached 01_meeting_transcript_evidence.csv. Role: Act as an independent Senior Delivery Manager. Ask: Extract decisions, actions, risks and unresolved questions; attach line IDs and distinguish commitments from estimates. Format: Executive finding | Evidence reference | FACT/ASSUMPTION/INFERENCE/UNKNOWN | Required validation | Owner/decision. Test: Create columns: item, classification, source line, owner (if stated), deadline (if stated), validation needed. Do not invent names, dates or approvals.

Verification key (for facilitator): Sponsor requested a Friday decision, NOT an approved Friday launch. Four of six scenarios passed; one failed, one not run. Patch estimate is conditional. Finance cost exposure is unquantified.

Participant submission: Original prompt, raw AI output, corrected final output, evidence references, and two lessons learned.

Facilitator challenge: Introduce one misleading AI claim and ask the participant to identify it and explain the business consequence.

LAB 2 — Sprint and dependency analysis

Input: 02_sprint_delivery.csv

Management objective: Compare Done versus accepted work, isolate blocked items and identify unsupported completion forecasts.

Copy-ready CRAFT prompt:

Context: I am conducting a fictional IT delivery management exercise using the attached 02_sprint_delivery.csv. Role: Act as an independent Senior Delivery Manager. Ask: Compare Done versus accepted work, isolate blocked items and identify unsupported completion forecasts. Format: Executive finding | Evidence reference | FACT/ASSUMPTION/INFERENCE/UNKNOWN | Required validation | Owner/decision. Test: Report story IDs and point totals by exact status. Separate Done from accepted; flag missing acceptance. Identify dependencies and unknown critical-path implications.

Verification key (for facilitator): Done=18 points (8+5+5), but ST-106 lacks confirmed acceptance. Blocked items ST-103, ST-105 and ST-107. ST-104 80% is an unverified statement, not 80% of story points.

Participant submission: Original prompt, raw AI output, corrected final output, evidence references, and two lessons learned.

Facilitator challenge: Introduce one misleading AI claim and ask the participant to identify it and explain the business consequence.

LAB 3 — Connected risk intelligence

Input: 03_raid_and_dependencies.csv

Management objective: Build an evidence-linked risk network and escalation triggers without predicting certainty.

Copy-ready CRAFT prompt:

Context: I am conducting a fictional IT delivery management exercise using the attached 03_raid_and_dependencies.csv. Role: Act as an independent Senior Delivery Manager. Ask: Build an evidence-linked risk network and escalation triggers without predicting certainty. Format: Executive finding | Evidence reference | FACT/ASSUMPTION/INFERENCE/UNKNOWN | Required validation | Owner/decision. Test: Show linked risks/issues/dependencies, evidence, owners, trigger, next verification action, and a balanced executive summary.

Verification key (for facilitator): D-01 is linked to R-01; I-01 compounds test exposure; A-01 is unvalidated; D-02 is a separate design dependency. No guaranteed milestone failure is established.

Participant submission: Original prompt, raw AI output, corrected final output, evidence references, and two lessons learned.

Facilitator challenge: Introduce one misleading AI claim and ask the participant to identify it and explain the business consequence.

LAB 4 — Financial decision support

Input: 04_financial_scenarios.csv

Management objective: Calculate baseline EAC/VAC and margin, then model explicitly labeled sensitivity cases.

Copy-ready CRAFT prompt:

Context: I am conducting a fictional IT delivery management exercise using the attached 04_financial_scenarios.csv. Role: Act as an independent Senior Delivery Manager. Ask: Calculate baseline EAC/VAC and margin, then model explicitly labeled sensitivity cases. Format: Executive finding | Evidence reference | FACT/ASSUMPTION/INFERENCE/UNKNOWN | Required validation | Owner/decision. Test: Recalculate with arithmetic shown. Distinguish working ETC from actuals. Do not automatically add scenario costs to ETC or count proposed savings as realized.

Verification key (for facilitator): Working EAC=$645,000; VAC=–$45,000; working contribution=$105,000; gross margin=14.0% of $750,000 revenue. If $30,000 is incremental and not already in ETC, EAC=$675,000 and margin=10.0%; this is a scenario, not a forecast.

Participant submission: Original prompt, raw AI output, corrected final output, evidence references, and two lessons learned.

Facilitator challenge: Introduce one misleading AI claim and ask the participant to identify it and explain the business consequence.

LAB 5 — Release readiness decision pack

Input: 05_release_readiness.csv

Management objective: Draft a conditional readiness brief for an authorized go/no-go meeting.

Copy-ready CRAFT prompt:

Context: I am conducting a fictional IT delivery management exercise using the attached 05_release_readiness.csv. Role: Act as an independent Senior Delivery Manager. Ask: Draft a conditional readiness brief for an authorized go/no-go meeting. Format: Executive finding | Evidence reference | FACT/ASSUMPTION/INFERENCE/UNKNOWN | Required validation | Owner/decision. Test: Show evidence for each gate, unresolved tests, dependencies, authorization status, options, and questions for accountable leads. Do not declare release approved.

Verification key (for facilitator): Four passed, one failed, one not run. Regression incomplete; vendor patch unconfirmed; formal authorization absent. Release readiness cannot be established from supplied data.

Participant submission: Original prompt, raw AI output, corrected final output, evidence references, and two lessons learned.

Facilitator challenge: Introduce one misleading AI claim and ask the participant to identify it and explain the business consequence.

Capstone — integrated leadership decision pack

Combine all five datasets only after recording their separate reporting cutoffs and possible inconsistencies. Prepare a two-page executive pack: current position, verified evidence, three principal exposures, finance sensitivity, decisions required, responsible owners, and explicit unknowns. Add a one-page AI verification log. Do not assert that the datasets represent a single synchronized project snapshot.

Assessment rubric (100 points)

Dimension	Points	Observable standard
Prompt design and task clarity	15	CRAFT, defined output, source constraints
Evidence traceability	25	Correct line/story/check IDs, no unsupported claims
Analytical accuracy	20	Correct status arithmetic and finance calculations
Management judgment	20	Clear alternatives, owners, triggers, human authority
Governance and reproducibility	20	Approved tool, review log, data boundaries, repeatable workflow

Suggested pass: 80/100 with no critical control failure. Critical failures include invented approval, confidential data misuse, or an uncorrected material financial error. A facilitator should verify independently.

Pilot scorecard

Measure	Baseline	Pilot	Review rule
Total cycle time (including review)	_____	_____	Compare equivalent work

Measure	Baseline	Pilot	Review rule
Supported material claims / checked	_____	_____	Record sample and severity
Material rework rate	_____	_____	Include all correction time
Decision completeness	_____	_____	Owner, ask, checkpoint
Control failures	_____	_____	Stop and investigate

Trainer rollout

Week 1: Chapters 1–3 and Lab 1. Week 2: Chapters 4–7 and Labs 2–3. Week 3: Chapters 8–10 and Lab 4. Week 4: Chapter 11, Lab 5 and capstone. Collect a baseline before training; conduct independent scoring; scale only workflows with documented quality and net benefit.

Digital lab submission template

Learner: _____ | Date: _____ | Approved tool/model: _____ | Dataset version: _____ | Prompt version: _____ | Reviewer: _____

Output file: _____ | Material claims checked: _____ | Corrections: _____ | Decision authority: _____ | Final disposition: _____